



BRANDING

Guidelines

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PINELLAS COUNTY BRAND GUIDELINES

The following information and guidelines are intended to help county staff, vendors and contractors in creating materials that support the overall brand identity.

What is a Brand?

Our brand is more than the county logo. Our brand is the way people see the county. It’s what people think of us. At the core of any brand is the organization’s goals and values. These should lead people to develop an impression of us over time from what we say, how we look, and what we do. Our goal is for people to have a good impression of Pinellas County, and then to connect that good impression to our logo and other aspects of our visual identity.

Over time, the logo and other elements of our visual identity serve as shortcuts—cues—to bring out a person’s impression of the county. A person sees the logo and we want them to immediately have a positive response based on their existing good impression of the county. We then want to reinforce that good impression.

What Are Our Goals and Values?

Pinellas County’s vision and mission, strategic plan and values statements do an excellent job of laying the groundwork for the county’s brand. They are as follows:

Vision

To be the standard for public service in America.

Mission

Pinellas County Government is committed to progressive public policy, superior public service, courteous public contact, judicious exercise of authority, and responsible management of public resources to meet the needs and concerns of our citizens today and tomorrow.

To achieve our vision, we place the highest importance on:

- Quality Service
- Respectful Engagement
- Responsible Resource Management

Strategic Plan

The Pinellas County Strategic Plan lays out the county’s priorities:

- Create a Quality Workforce in a Positive, Supportive Organization
- Ensure Public Health, Safety, and Welfare
- Practice Superior Environmental Stewardship
- Foster Continual Economic Growth and Vitality
- Deliver First-Class Services to the Public and Our Customers

Our Values

- We will be respectful of the needs of individuals while recognizing our responsibility to the community as a whole.
- We will be community-centric, embracing the individuality of partners working together as one, toward the community’s vitality.
- We believe it is our responsibility to improve the overall quality of life through the management and preservation of the natural and built environment.
- We will provide open and accountable governance.
- We will foster a diverse work culture, a safe workplace, and opportunity for professional and personal growth.

Pinellas County’s Brand Position Statement

The Pinellas County brand is anchored in trust. This trust is built on four things:

1. Customer service
2. Smart use of resources
3. Partnerships
4. Getting things done

A brand position statement serves as a shortcut to help staff understand the brand and ensure that programs, activities, communications and interactions all reinforce and strengthen the brand. Such a statement is not the same as a slogan and is not used publicly. Pinellas County’s brand position can be summarized as follows:

- Pinellas is the county people trust to make life better today and in the future. We earn this trust by making customers our first priority, making smart decisions and getting things done.

Pinellas County’s Brand Attributes

Based on the above, the Pinellas County brand identity materials should convey through our design, typography, videography, photography and writing that the county is:

Confident

- Knowledgeable, not academic, authoritarian or bossy.

Innovative, forward-thinking, contemporary

- Worthy of trust, not stodgy or out-of-date.

Welcoming

- Happy to help, approachable, easy to understand.
- Appreciative of diversity and partnerships.
People-focused, not confusing or institutional.

Appreciative

- Grateful for the great things in our county and of the work we do.

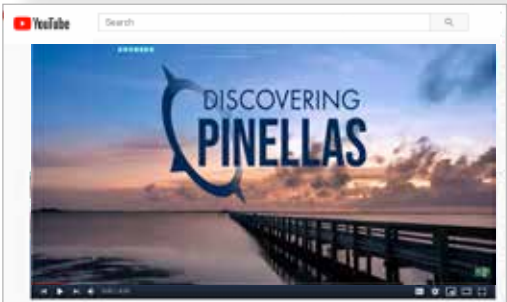
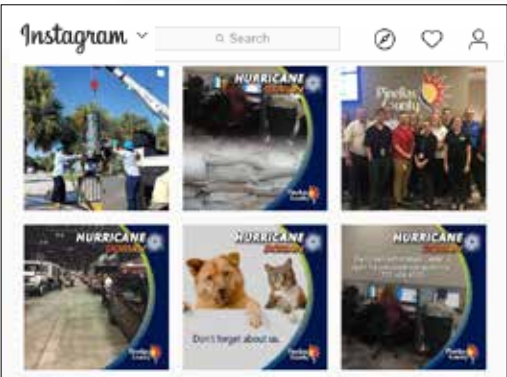
In-Touch

- Understanding what matters to our many constituencies and able to relate to them.

Professional

- Well managed, organized, smart, sensible, trustworthy, not sloppy, cluttered, or unfocused.

These are internal guidelines, not something we publish.



The County Logo

The Board of County Commissioners has chosen our logo to provide a highly recognizable symbol to identify Pinellas County. The logo is used on all media, from signs to letterhead to videos, and helps cut through the information clutter our residents and visitors encounter every day. (For logo exemptions see the end of this document.)

As part of the county’s brand refresh in 2019, the logo is often reversed out of a blue wave. This new treatment is intended to refresh the look of the logo and give it more visual impact without redesigning it. **OPTI Players** is the font for **Pinellas County** words in Pinellas County’s logo.

There are times when it is important to identify the public-facing department or division, such as on building and vehicle signs. When this is needed, the following format will be used:



Department or public facing workgroup name is set in Nirmala Bold UI.

Distance from top of capitals to baseline of the word "County" is twice the distance of the descender of the "y".

Text is flush left and does not extend beyond the end of the middle sun ray.



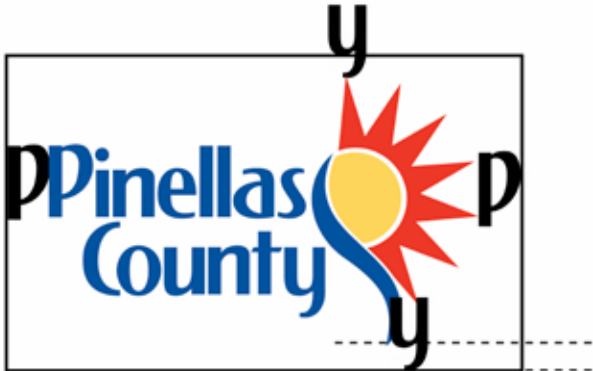
The minimum size of the logo with a department or division name is one 1.5 inches wide. If it were smaller, the type for the division name would be too small.

The minimum size of the logo by itself is **1 inch wide**.

Clear Zone Around the Logo

When placing the logo, do not crowd it next to other graphics or the edge of a page.

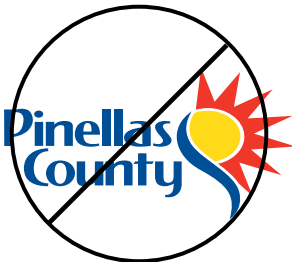
Keep clear the **width** of the letter "p" on the left and right. Keep the **height** of the descender of the lower case "y" clear at the top and bottom.



Clear zone around logo

For the logo to be effective, it must be used consistently. The following rules apply to the use of the logo:

- 1. Never distort the logo when resizing it. Hold down the shift key when you resize the logo to keep the correct proportions.
- 2. Do not add or delete graphic elements or connect them with any other mark, logo, graphic element or symbol.
- 3. Never allow the Pinellas County logo to be used by non-Pinellas County users in their own literature unless Pinellas County is a sponsor of the event or program. Approval must first be granted by Administration. Do not combine the County logo with any other logo or artwork, unless expressly approved.
- 4. Do not use the logo on busy backgrounds that obscure the logo.



Do not stretch the logo



Do not resize individual elements.



Do not use busy backgrounds.



Do not add text to the logo



Do not use just the sun and rays part of the logo with a phrase



Do not use just the sun and rays as individual elements

Logo Colors

Consistent use of colors helps build a coordinated and recognizable identity for Pinellas County.

The logo may be reproduced only in one color or three colors. It should never be produced in two colors or other color combinations.



Logo colors for print

	Blue:	C 100	M 72	Y 2	K 2
	Yellow:	C 0	M 6	Y 95	K 0
	Red:	C 0	M 96	Y 95	K 0

Logo colors for digital

	Blue:	R 47	G 74	B 137
	Yellow:	R 243	G 213	B 43
	Red:	R 198	G 0	B 54

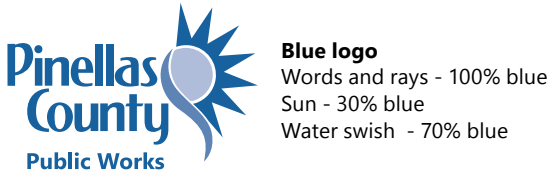
Logo colors in Pantone Matching System

	Blue:	653c		Blue:	287u
	Yellow:	128c		Yellow:	108u
	Red:	1795c		Red:	485u

Logo colors for digital use in hexadecimal

	Blue:	#2F4A89		Blue:	H222 S65 B53
	Yellow:	#F3D52B		Yellow:	H51 S82 B95
	Red:	#C60036		Red:	H343 S100 B77

One-Color Application of Logo



Secondary Colors

The following complimentary colors are suggested for graphic elements (excluding the logo) in collateral and other marketing materials that reflect the five branches of the strategic plan.

	Pantone PMS 267c		Process	C 75	M 100	Y 0	K 0
	Pantone PMS 485c		Process	C 0	M 90	Y 85	K 0
	Pantone PMS 3425c		Process	C 90	M 30	Y 95	K 30
	Pantone PMS 3262c		Process	C 80	M 10	Y 45	K 0
	Pantone PMS 109c		Process	C 0	M 32	Y 100	K 0

For primary color values (Pantone, CMYK, RGB and Hexidecimal), please refer to single and multi-color application pages in this guide.

Logo on a Dark Blue Background

Type is white. The icon maintains the original color specs, with an added white border.

The logo should only be reversed out of a dark blue and black gradient as shown in the sample layouts in this document.



This darker blue is similar to Pantone 289c or:

C 100 M 50 Y 0 K 59

R 0 G 36 B 76

Hexadecimal – #00244C

Contact Communications if you would like to have an exception reviewed.



Design Elements

The following design elements are to be used to create complementary materials. Each design can be unique, but must fit within the overall family appearance to continue to build a consistent and strong visual identity.

Shapes: Circle and Wave

Two primary shapes from the Pinellas County Logo—the circle and the wave—are incorporated into designs to create a design system that reinforces our brand. These shapes are used to create layouts that have visual interest and are more organic than rigid—more fluid than boxy—much like our beautiful coastline. The shortcut for designers to remember is “Pinellas County: we’re not square.”

Repeated use of these elements will create a stronger visual identity for the county over time.

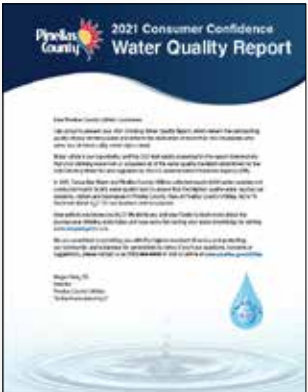
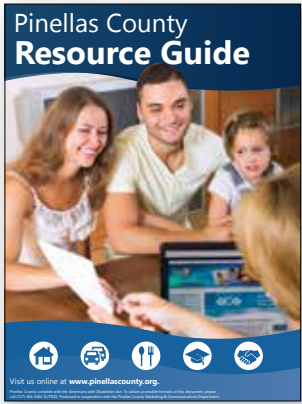
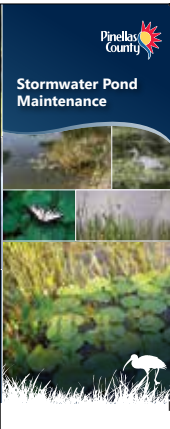
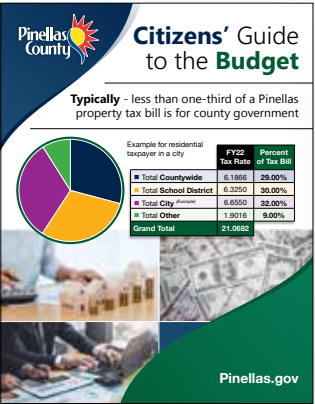
In using these shapes, do not outline them. On a second wave, a second, accent color is optional.

Use of White Space

Layouts of printed materials should not be too dense and crowded; this results in a document that is uninviting and often goes unread. Layouts should be written and designed to be easy to scan, visually open, appealing and accessible.

ADA Compliance

Pinellas County complies with Section 508 of federal Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA). Visit: www.section508.gov/create for information about creating accessible digital documents for use on Pinellas County’s website. All visuals must contain proper contrast for visibly-impaired citizens. Use <https://contrastchecker.com> to check appropriate contrast of text color.



Typography

The primary typeface used for Pinellas County materials is **Nirmala UI**.

The use of large, bold headings to create strong contrast on the page is encouraged. Usually these are in **Nirmala UI Bold**.

Body copy is usually set in Nirmala UI Regular 11 pt. or 12 pt. Calibri is an acceptable alternative. **OPTI Players** is the font for the words **Pinellas County** in Pinellas County’s logo.

Text is set flush left rather than justified.

Other typefaces may be used; however, the overall look should not be changed too dramatically by the choice of type.

When Setting Type, Always:

- Maintain consistent letter spacing. Do not create speed bumps of **compressed type like this** to save space.
- Use hyphens -
- En dashes –
- Em dashes —

Hyphens are used only for hyphenated words. En dashes are used to indicate a range (such as 5–9 or noon–1:00. Em dashes (—) indicate an interruption in thought. Hyphens and dashes should be set without space around them.

- Use only one space after a period. (Search and replace to resolve.)

Fonts

Nirmala UI Bold

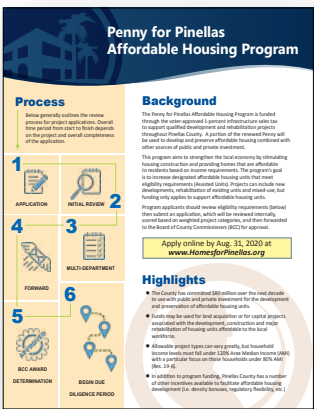
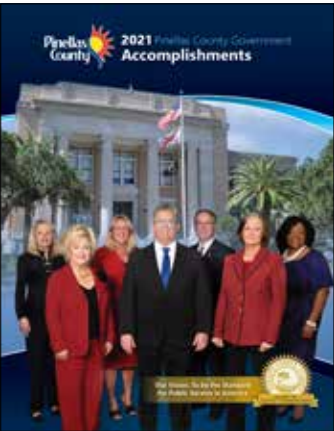
Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm Nn Oo Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 Pinellas County

Nirmala UI Regular

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm Nn Oo Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 Pinellas County

Nirmala UI Semilight

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj Kk Ll Mm Nn Oo Qq Rr Ss Tt Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 Pinellas County



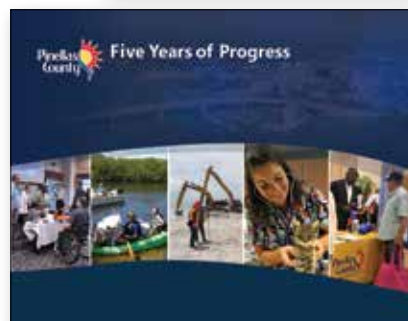
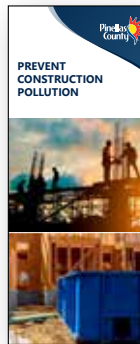
Type Considerations

- Do not leave single words ending a paragraph wrapped up to the top of a column (widows). Work with the author to edit for these or re-hyphenate the paragraph or change the length of columns to prevent.
- Do not set large amounts of body copy in light color on a dark background.
- Do not set body copy over photographs or backgrounds that make it difficult to read.
- Do not outline type.
- Do not use underlines.
- Do not hyphenate words in headlines or any level of heading. A headline that contains a hyphenated adjective, "It was a fast-paced race" is acceptable.
- Do not use italicized text in large amounts such as for long quotes. Italic (oblique for sans serif) is more difficult to read and often is less attractive, especially for sans serif typefaces for which a custom oblique version was not created.

Photography

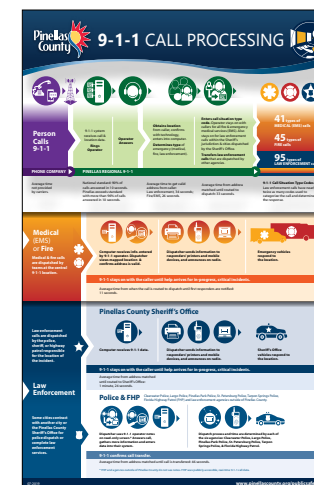
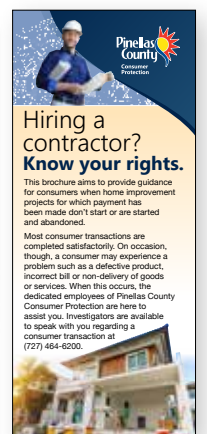
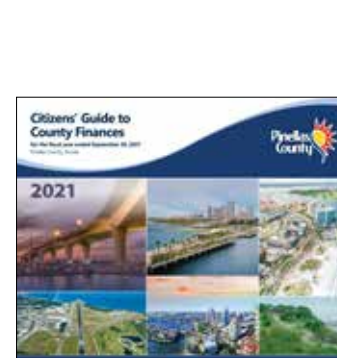
Photography is a strong element used to build the Pinellas County brand. To reinforce our brand position, photography should follow these guidelines:

- Action photos are preferred
- When possible use close-ups of people who are engaged with the camera, another person or something else in the picture.
- Candid shots are preferred over posed shots.
- Original photographs are preferred over stock photography.
- Photos are often cropped in the circle or wave shape, giving them more visual interest while reinforcing the design elements of the brand.
- Silhouetted images in color of people with the background removed are often used to create more visual interest and to prevent the boxy look that traditional photographs can have.
- Use Pinellas photos as much as possible.
- Use photos to communicate the look and feel of Pinellas County.



Graphic Elements and Treatment

- Use treatments that look contemporary and energetic, such as silhouettes, cropping into circles, etc.
- Avoid heavy rules that add visual clutter.
- Strokes around photographs are discouraged. If strokes are needed for an illustration or other material in a layout, keep them thin.

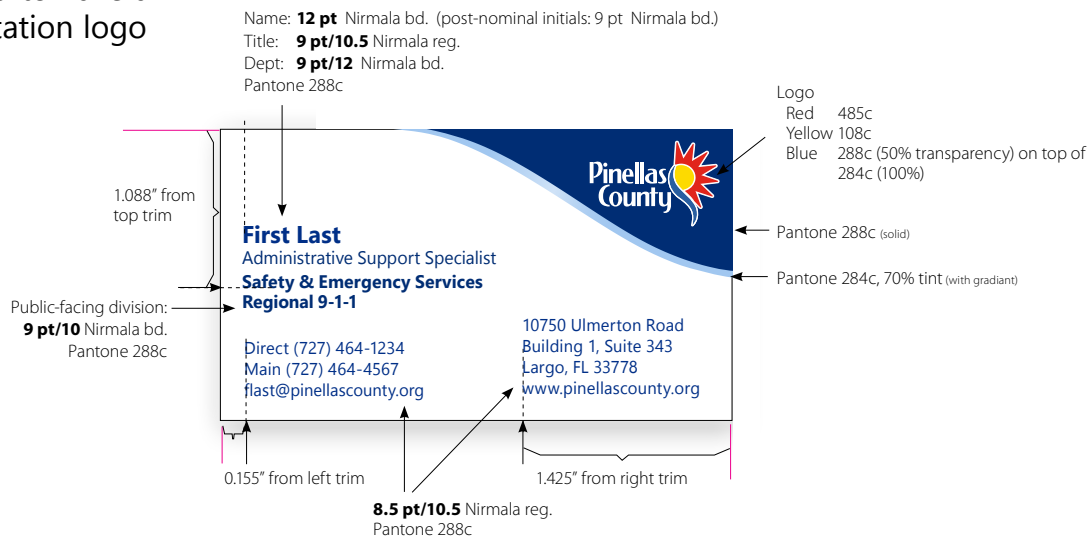


Business Cards

The title/position/department name block should not exceed four lines.
The address/homepage block should only include the Pinellas County business address and the Pinellas County web address.
The telephone/email block should include direct office phone number, main office phone number and Pinellas County email address. It should not include personal email addresses or websites, or fax numbers.
Dimensions: 2" x 3.5"

Stock: Cougar Opaque Smooth White 80 lb., cover weight (recycle fiber mix)

Special note: Pinellas County Public Works business cards are allowed to have a secondary, APWA accreditation logo on their business cards.



This buissness card template is available to order from the Clerk's Printing Services at <https://printingservices.co.pinellas.fl.us/> under the "Printing Order" top menu tab and clicking the "Business Cards" category.

Envelope

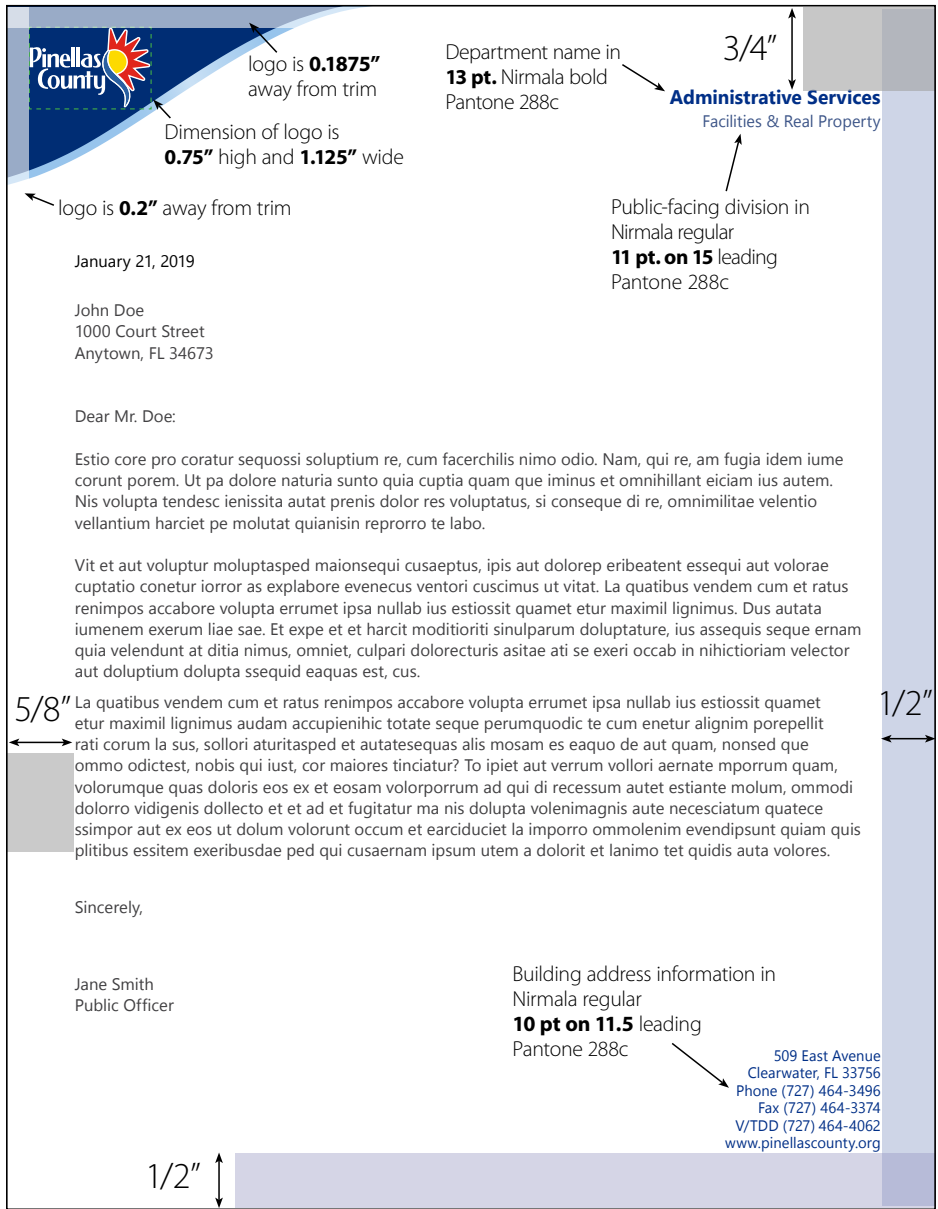
The department name and address block should not exceed five lines.



Letterhead

The primary purpose of printed information on the letterhead is to provide location information for responses. The building, city, state and 5-digit zip code are flush right in the bottom right corner. The stationery should also include the office telephone numbers with area code in parenthesis.

Order letterhead at <https://printingservices.co.pinellas.fl.us/> under the "Printing Order" top menu tab and clicking the "3 Color County Letterhead 8 1/2" X 11" category.



Embroidery

Pinellas County staff shirts feature the logo with 'Pinellas County' in a white thread and three Pantone colors for the sun:

- Pantone blue: 653 coated
- Pantone yellow: 128 coated
- Pantone red: 1795 coated

The preferred shirt color is Pantone 7454 c. The dimensions of the embroidery should be approximately 2 ¼" tall x 3" wide.

Department names are optional. Please contact Communications if you would like to have an eps file prepared for a vendor.



Name Badges

Department directors may purchase name badges for employees who work directly with the public. Name badges identify employees by name and department or in some cases, public-facing division. The badges may be purchased at www.pinellasrubberstamp.com. Click on "New to our site?" to begin registration or contact (727) 545-0575 to register. Pinellas Rubber Stamp has an online intake form to key in the desired name badge information.



16 pt **Nirmala Bold, Name**
14 pt Nirmala Regular, Dept
/17 leading

287 blue

Other County Logos

As a general rule, programs and services under the BCC use the main county logo. By using the logo consistently across departments, we reinforce that we are all one county government and we strengthen the logo's ability to cut through the clutter and help our programs and services be recognized as county programs.

Creating division- or program-level logos that are unrelated to the county logo can erode the strength of the county brand and can cause confusion about whether a program or service is provided by the county. For this reason, we do not generally create logos for programs.

When do we make exceptions?

1. **When a program or service needs to build unique personality and has a purpose that is not generally thought of as closely tied to the county's core functions and identity.** For example, the Florida Botanical Gardens benefits from having its own identity that helps to promote it as a tourism destination. In this case, the Gardens has its own logo, with the tagline "A Pinellas County Government Program" to ensure that the County receives recognition for funding the program. Similarly, Visit St. Pete/Clearwater is the public-facing brand for tourism. It benefits tourism promotion to focus on primary tourist destinations rather than on our county government, so a separate brand is used.
2. **When a program is a coalition of a variety of organizations that equally sponsor and participate,** such as the Stormwater Wastewater Partnership. While such initiatives do not always need a logo, there may be times when one is warranted.
3. **When there is a need to create a strong visual identity and positive sentiment about a specific campaign and little need to associate that with the county government.** For example, the Penny for Pinellas is a brand that has been used for years to provide objective information about how the infrastructure sales tax is used. As a stand-alone brand, it can be adopted by other municipalities in the county.

Division Logos

Exemptions from the Pinellas County logo

The following logos are grandfathered in from previous exemptions:

Economic Development logo with tagline,
A Pinellas County Government Program



South Cross Bayou Water Reclamation Facility logo
with tagline, *A Pinellas County Government Program*



Pinellas County Extension logo



Florida Botanical Gardens logo with tagline,
A Pinellas County Government Program



Heritage Village logo with tagline,
A Pinellas County Government Program



Brooker Creek Preserve logo with tagline,
A Pinellas County Government Program



Weedon Island Preserve logo with tagline,
A Pinellas County Government Program



Star Center logo with tagline,
A Pinellas County Government Program



PIE logo for St. Pete Clearwater International Airport



Wastewater • Stormwater logo for a
Pinellas partnership



Visit St. Pete/Clearwater logo for
VSPC Convention & Visitors Bureau



Forward Pinellas logo



Watershed logo for
Public Works Environmental Department



Sunstar logo with tagline,
A Pinellas County Government Service



